



High-End Smartphone (35-50K)

Powerhour of performance

This year, high-end smartphones came of age and were quite aggressively priced as well. This gave buyers a lot of choice when it came to this particular segment. The best high-end smartphones showcase solid performance, breaking many previous records in our benchmarking tests for Android phones. What's more, is that these phones do not put a dent in your pocket but they also do not compromise on the performance and features. Now, these phones may not be THE best phones (we've got a separate category for that) we encountered this year, but these are definitely the phones that should be on top of your list if you are looking for a high-end smartphone that strikes a balance between performance, display, cameras, battery life and of course, price. These smartphones are more of the sensible ones that folks would want to buy rather than throwing money at the most expensive thing that money can get.

Winner: iQOO 7 Legend

When it comes to sheer raw performance, the iQOO 7 Legend has been breaking all existing records this year. It is a very powerful phone that offers a smooth and lag-free experience. If you're looking for a phone for daily use and occasional gaming, you'll be surprised at the optimisations iQOO provides that result in overall sustained performance. For the iQOO 7 Legend, the company sought inspiration from its BMW Motorsport partnership and the phone has a track design on the back with a matte finish that feels good in the hand. The iQOO 7 Legend uses a bright and vivid display that supports a fast touch response rate along with an impressive camera stack that you can depend on for your everyday photography needs. It's the whole package.

Runner Up: OnePlus 9

Coming in as our runner up is the OnePlus



iQOO 7 Legend

Price: Starting at ₹39,990



OnePlus 9

Price: Starting at ₹44,999



Realme GT

Price: Starting at ₹37,999

9 which only lags by a few points over the iQOO 7 Legend. Otherwise, the OnePlus 9 is a flagship-grade phone that offers a premium design and strikes the perfect balance between price and performance. Even though the OnePlus 9 isn't as affordable as our winner here, it leads in the display and the battery life departments which are also very important aspects to consider when buying an affordable flagship smartphone. The cameras on the OnePlus 9 also offer better day-light and low-light performance and the Hasselblad collaboration does deliver a superior photography experience.

Best Buy: Realme GT

Realme left no stone unturned this year as it ventured into the high-end territory with the Realme GT which also happens to be one of the most affordable phones powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon 888 chip. In our tests, the Realme GT demonstrated flagship-like performance and is adept at multitasking and gaming. However, due to its thin and lightweight profile, thermals are bound to catch up in the way of sustained performance. It has a Super AMOLED display that is great for watching videos and also supports a 120 Hz refresh rate. So overall, you get an all-rounder that is light on the pocket, both figuratively and literally!

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